

Fun @ Work

All work and no play could actually be affecting your bottom-line as a business, or your productivity as an employee!

Agent 001

Studies have shown that dull, boring corporate environments may not be the best enabler of quality work. A little humour goes a long way in livening up the atmosphere, and it builds friendships—an essential ingredient in the building of a good team. A lot of corporate studies have shown that a cheery work atmosphere results in better teamwork, more productivity, lower attrition rates, and an overall enhancement in output quality.

A survey conducted by the Gallup Organization (www.gallup.com) of millions of office workers around the globe has shown that having close friends at work improves a worker's job satisfaction by almost 50 per cent! The same study, in sharp contrast, showed that one third of the 80,000 bosses polled thought "office friendships" should be frowned upon—talk about not knowing what your employees want, or need! Especially considering that the study also showed that the majority of employees would rather have a friend at work than even a 10 per cent pay hike, and employees with three or more close friends at work were actually 96 per cent happier with their lives and their salaries!

There are more studies that say offices should be designed in a fun way, or that management should hold non-work-related gather-

ings for friends and families of employees to encourage friendships and bonding, but let's leave that for now. What's more important is that employees learn to open up a bit, let their hair down and have a little laugh every now and then, so long as it doesn't affect their work.

We will digress from formal business articles here in order to give you some hints as to what you can do to liven up the atmosphere.

Tech Pranks

One of the easiest ways to break the ice amidst a group of employees is a harmless prank—with emphasis on *harmless*! Nothing makes opening up to one another easier than laughter, and you're guaranteed to get some if you pull some of the pranks we're listing here. Remember, these are just a few ideas, or pranks that people have actually pulled, and you're limited only by your own creativity! What's important is that you choose your victims wisely—not everyone will find humour in having a prank pulled on him or her, so make sure you choose a person with a sporting attitude...

Switch

One of the oldest yet best pranks involving computers is to switch people's keyboards or mice. You could even switch monitors! This works best when you have two people sharing a desk or cubicle, facing each other, with cabinets on the

